

Manifest File Importer Runbook

Summary

The Manifest File Importer allows customers to import multiple projects in bulk using a manifest configuration file. This method is useful for migrating entire groups or organizations from other platforms into GitLab. The manifest must be an XML file up to 1 MB in size. GitLab requires PostgreSQL for manifest imports to work, as subgroups are needed for the import process. This runbook provides support engineers with troubleshooting guidance for common manifest import failures.

Troubleshooting

For comprehensive information about manifest file format and configuration, see the Manifest File Importer Documentation.

Common issues include:

- **Import fails with manifest file validation error:** Verify manifest file format is valid YAML/JSON and all required fields are present
- **Some projects import successfully, others fail:** Check project configuration, URLs, and repository access
- **Import hangs or times out:** Monitor Sidekiq progress, increase timeouts, or consider importing in batches for large manifests
- **Projects imported but data is incomplete:** Verify manifest configuration includes data import settings

Links to Further Documentation

- [Manifest File Importer Documentation](#)